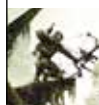


Tablets will replace PCs?

Was Apple CEO Tim Cook wrong when he said that the "post-PC revolution" is upon us? Find out why <http://dgit.in/Jp472i>



Crysis 3 in 2013

EA's announced Crysis 3 will hit store shelves in 2013, and Prophet will return to a Cell Corporation Nanodome-encased New York <http://dgit.in/JzyCR9>

with panels whose black levels aren't that great. The Samsung monitor for instance merged as many as five to six blocks and also had a slight greenish tinge in the grey coloured boxes. The HD movie viewing experience was good in most of the monitors. Scrolling text readability was not really great on the Samsung monitor.

24-INCHES

This category was dominated by the BenQ monitors with only Dell U2412M providing some competition. We also see a variety of panels in this segment namely TN, VA and IPS. The Dell U2412M sports a 24-inch eIPS panel with an aspect ratio of 16:10 which allows it to pack in more pixels than the 16:9 aspect ratio based BenQ monitors. On first glance, the Dell monitor looks quite professional, with a

thick profile, ability to swivel, tilt and adjust the height. We liked the Energy indicator atop the Brightness and Contrast controls. The build is rock-steady and viewing angles on this IPS display are very good indeed.

Of the BenQ monitors, the XL2420T stands out as a high end monitor when compared with the competitors. The XL2420T is a 3D LED backlit LCD monitor, targeted at gamers, with special options to save up to three gamer profiles. You will also be presented with a long list of preset options from your regular

Standard, Movie, Text to FPS profiles. It comes bundled with an S-switch which basically allows you to control the OSD with the help of three buttons and a scroll wheel. There are many options to tweak around on this monitor but you have to make do with touch-sensitive

buttons on the monitor bezel. The Black equalizer option allows get more details out of the shadowy areas, without affecting the brighter portions on the screen, a really nifty feature to have.

BenQ EW2430 is a PVA panel based monitor. It comes on a sturdy silver coloured stand sporting a glossy black bezel. The OSD buttons located on the rear side of the monitor, are a bit uncomfortable to use and even though the usability of the OSD is great, you will take some time to learn how to operate it blindly. Two HDMI ports along with a DVI and DSub port, give you options to add more devices to the monitor. The speakers on the monitor are ordinary at best.

Apart from the high end monitors, BenQ also has some budget offerings in terms of GL2450 and RL2450H. GL2450 is your standard home use monitor whereas the RL2450H has been developed keeping RTS gamers in mind, offering an RTS preset mode and it also has the Black Equalizer feature seen on the high end XL2420T which allows you to brighten darker areas in a game, without blowing out the brighter areas. It's crucial if your monitor tends to darken the enemies while gaming.

In terms of performance, the EW2430 offered an amazing contrast ratio of around 1439:1 at 100 per cent brightness and 50 per cent contrast. The Dell U2412M gave mediocre contrast ratio of around 223:1 at standard setting, we could manage to get the contrast ratio over 500:1 on using the text preset mode. The black levels offered by the XL2420T were quite good and the gaming experience was flawless. The Black



BenQ XL2420T

HOW WE TESTED

We divided the monitors received into categories based on their screen sizes. As far as features went, we logged all the physical specifications on the monitors including details of the panel, connectivity options, swivelling options, USB ports, etc. Build Quality was evaluated and scored accordingly. We also evaluated the on-screen display options and its ease of use.

Our test bed comprised of the following components:

- Processor: Intel Core i7-3960X
- Motherboard: Intel DX79SI
- RAM: 8 GB DDR3 RAM @ 1333MHz
- SSD: Kingston HyperX 240GB SSD
- Graphics Card: NVIDIA GTX 590 (with the 3D Vision kit for 3D monitors)

We used Spyder 3 Elite to calibrate each display and also to give

us the real contrast ratio and luminance value. Manufacturer's specified contrast ratios are determined under certain conditions and at specific brightness and contrast levels. While the luminance is calculated at 100 percent brightness, we noticed that it was not the correct level for calculating Contrast ratio, as some monitors showed heavy backlight bleeding on maximum brightness. So to calculate contrast ratio with the Spyder 3 Elite colorimeter, we calculated Contrast ratios with brightness levels at 100 percent and 50 percent, as most use cases will have the brightness within this limit. All monitors were tested on Standard Mode with User Colour feature activated for us to be able to tweak each of the RGB sliders. All enhancement options were disabled.

The calibrated monitors (at 50 percent brightness level) were

then subjected to Lagom.nl tests which basically involves checking the black and white gradients, black level, white level, pixel walk (inversion), contrast etc.

Our movie test comprised a set of two 1080p clips which encompassed a mix of natural scenery, fast moving action scenes and scenes involving humans. We looked for the colour rendition, skin tones, noise and contrast levels and 5-6 particular spots in the HD clips. Each spot was given a score out of 10 based on the output and resistance to backlight bleeding. These scores were then averaged to get one single score per HD clip.

Viewing angles were also evaluated for text, movie and game display. PixPerAn was used to evaluate how well the monitor could enable readability of scrolling text.